An EBS volume is separate from an EC2 instance and connected over the network, as shown in figure 8.1. EBS volumes have the following characteristics:

- They aren't part of your EC2 instances; they're attached to your EC2 instance via a network connection. If you terminate your EC2 instance, the EBS volumes remain.
- They are either not attached to an EC2 instance or attached to exactly one EC2 instance at a time.
- They can be used like typical hard disks.
- They replicate your data on multiple disks to prevent data loss due to hardware failures.

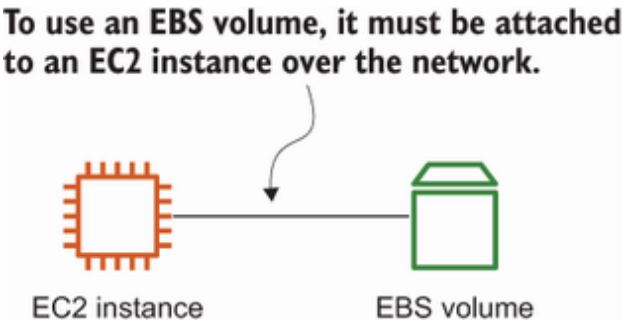


Figure 8.1 EBS volumes are independent resources but can be used only when attached to an EC2 instance.

EBS volumes have one big advantage: they are not part of the EC2 instance; they are an independent resource. No matter whether you stop your virtual machine or your virtual machine fails because of a hardware defect, your volume and your data will remain.

By default, AWS sets the `DeleteOnTermination` attribute to `true` for the root volume of each EC2 instance. This means, whenever you terminate the EC2 instance, the EBS volume acting as the root